



LOCAL COMMUNITY STORY FOR ST. **MAURICE WEEKLY**

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MCpl C. Fillion on the left and Capt J. Guimond on the right during their deployment on Operation Impact in Iraq.

STABILITY IN THE MIDDLE EAST - A MAURICIEN'S CONTRIBUTION

Shawinigan, Québec – Last year, Captain Julien Guimond of the 62nd Field Artillery Regiment, from the city of Shawinigan, was deployed on Operation IMPACT. OP IMPACT is a Canadian Forces operation to build the military capabilities of Iraq, Jordan, and Lebanon and acts as a means to strengthen ties with allies in the region. Ultimately, the Canadian Government seeks to continue working with partners in the Middle East to set conditions for stability and security. The captain also had the privilege of participating in Operation AEGIS, which was the contribution of the Canadian Armed Forces to the evacuation of Afghans with significant ties to the Government of Canada, and their accompanying family members.

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Captain Julien Guimond is a native of Mauricie and although he is only 30 years old, this counts as his second deployment. During these two operations, which lasted approximately 10 months, the member held a position in operations in Kuwait and the position of liaison officer in Iraq. Though he now speaks it, Captain Guimond initially struggled with English but was able to learn quickly in just a matter of months. The member is proud to have participated in the evacuation of approximately 3,700 Afghans to Canada and contributed to the continuing efforts to bring peace and stability to the Middle East.

- 30 -

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